

Turkey vulture
Turkey vultures can't kill their own prey, so they eat animals that have already died instead. Animals that behave in this way are called scavengers.



A turkey vulture perches on a cactus.

Western deserts

Western North America has four deserts. These dry, sandy areas are hot during the day, but at night they can get very cold. Animals here must survive these tough conditions—and with very little water.



A short, or "bobbed," tail gives this wild cat its name. More than a million bobcats live in North America.



Bobcat

Great Salt Lake

SNAKE



Black-tailed jackrabbit

The jackrabbit can run up to 30 mph (48 kph) and jump 20 ft (6 m) into the air.

SIERRA NEVADA



Bighorn sheep

Male bighorns fight by crashing their big heads and horns together.

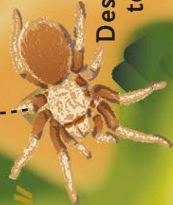
Colorado

This lizard lives mostly underground. It has a venomous bite and eats eggs.



Gila monster

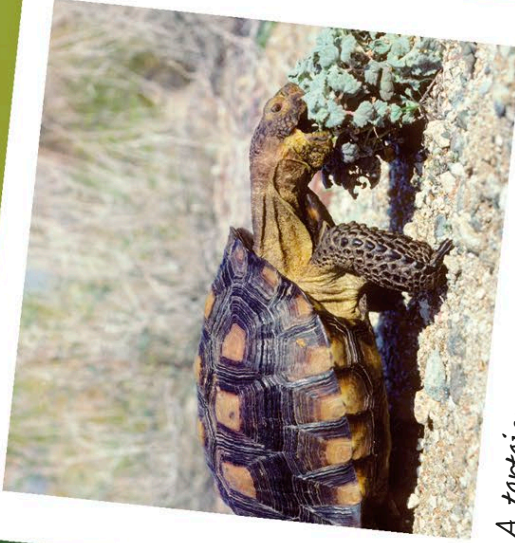
This big, hairy spider lines its desert burrow with silk to keep it from caving in.



Desert blonde tarantula

Desert broom

The desert broom's flowers provide sweet nectar for butterflies.



A tortoise snacks on a desert plant.

Mohave desert tortoise

This desert tortoise can live for up to 50 years. It digs a burrow to avoid the desert heat, and it spends 95 percent of its time there during the summer.